

RESEARCH AREAS

AOS: Philosophy of Language (formal semantics and pragmatics), Logic

AOC: Metaphysics, Epistemology, Metaethics

APPOINTMENTS

City University of New York (CUNY), Graduate Center Assistant Director of the Saul Kripke Center Research Associate	Sept 2025–Present
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EDUCATION

Rutgers University, New Brunswick Ph.D. in Philosophy Dissertation Title: <i>Semi-Opacity</i> Committee: Michael Glanzberg, Jeffrey King, Paul Pietroski, Jonathan Schaffer, Una Stojnić	Aug 2021–Aug 2025
University of Connecticut, Storrs M.A. in Philosophy	Aug 2018–Aug 2020
University of Cambridge M.Phil. in Philosophy	Sep 2016–Jun 2017
University of Chicago BA in Philosophy (<i>Summa Cum Laude</i> , Phi Beta Kappa)	Sep 2012–Jun 2016

RESEARCH

PUBLICATIONS:

- **The Complex Lives of Proper Names**, *Linguistics and Philosophy* 2023
On the semantics of proper names. I argue that names are predicates and rethink the syntax and semantics of definite descriptions to accommodate the rigidity of names.
DOI: 10.1007/s10988-023-09389-y
- **Epistemic Modality** (with Andy Egan), in *Cambridge Handbook of Natural Language Modality* (Eds. A. Arregui, V. Hacquard, & M. Ippolito). *forthcoming*
- **Introduction** (with Yale Weiss), in *Beyond the Outline: Fifty Years of Kripke on Truth* (Eno Agolli & Yale Weiss, Eds.), *Trends in Logic*, Springer. *forthcoming*

UNDER REVIEW

1. [REDACTED] On the truth-value of conditionals with impossible antecedents.
R & R at Synthese
2. [REDACTED] On analyzing modality in natural language as explicit quantification over and reference to possible worlds.
R & R at Journal of Semantics
3. [REDACTED] On a counterpart semantics for non-specific de re attitude reports.
Under Review at PPR
4. [REDACTED] On necessitarianism, the view that propositions are necessarily true if true.
Under Review at Philosophical Studies
5. [REDACTED] On a dynamic semantics that models retraction of assertions containing epistemic modals.
Under Review at Nous

IN PROGRESS

6. **The Epistemic *De Re***
On the interaction between singular terms and epistemic modals.
7. **Semantic Expressivism Redux**
On an expressivist semantics for deontic vocabulary based on assertibility conditions.
8. **Temporal and Modal Bound *De Re*** (with Michael Glanzberg, early stages)
On a special *de re* reading of tense.
9. **Belief Functions for Inquisitive Semantics** (with Giuliano Rosella, early stages)
On applying Dempster-Shafer theory to inquisitive contents.

CONFERENCES AND TALKS

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| 1. 2026 Eastern APA - Symposium Talk (Baltimore) | Jan 2026 |
| [REFEREED] Talk Title: "On Hats: Counterparts for Revisionist Reporting" | |
| 2. Logic and Metaphysics Workshop (CUNY) | Oct 2025 |
| [INVITED] Talk Title: "All Counterpossibles are False" | |
| 3. Philosophy of Language Workshop (NYU) | Apr 2024 |
| [INVITED] Talk Title: "Two-Dimensional Monsters" | |
| 4. Graduate Seminar in Analytic Philosophy (U of Athens) | Feb 2024 |
| [INVITED] Talk Title: "Counterpossibles and Presupposition Failure" | |
| 5. 2024 Eastern APA - Symposium Talk (New York) | Jan 2024 |
| [REFEREED] Talk Title: "Counterpossibles and Presupposition Failure" | |

6. **2nd Conference of Philosophy of Language Association**, (Freie U, Berlin) Jul 2023
[REFEREED] Talk Title: “Radical Schmentencism”
7. **13th Arché Conference**, (St Andrews) May 2023
[REFEREED] Talk Title: “Counterpossibles and Presupposition Failure”
8. **Syntactic Arguments in Contextualism/Relativism**, (Warsaw U) May 2023
[INVITED] Talk Title: “Radical Schmentencism”
9. **Exploring Expressivism**, (York U, Toronto) Apr 2023
[REFEREED] Talk Title: “Semantic Expressivism & Moral Language”
10. **Semantics Research Group**, (Yale U) Dec 2022
[INVITED] Talk Title: “The Complex Lives of Proper Names”
11. **4th FILOMENA workshop in Logic**, (U of Bergen) Oct 2019
[REFEREED] Talk Title: “Logical Nihilism”
12. **2018 Johns Hopkins Graduate Philosophy Conference** Nov 2018

DISTINCTIONS AND AWARDS

Marc Sanders Award for “On Hats” (Eastern APA)	Jan 2026
Fellowship at Life Worth Living Summer Program (Yale)	Jun 2023
NASSLLI Grant (USC)	Jun 2022
Jorgensen Fellowship (UConn)	2018 –2020
Tom Charlton Full Tuition Scholarship (Cambridge)	2016 –2017
Lee Family Best GPA in Philosophy Prize (UChicago)	Jun 2016
Phi Beta Kappa National Honors Society (UChicago)	Jun 2016
Adelman Full Tuition Merit Scholarship (UChicago)	2012 –2016

EDUCATION (OTHER)

European Summer School in Logic, Language and Information (34) Selected to give talk “Antiphrastic Evidentiality” (on Modern Greek particle <i>táha</i>) Unable to give talk due to illness	Jul-Aug 2023
North American Summer School in Logic, Language and Information	Jun 2022
European Summer School in Logic, Language and Information (32)	Jul-Aug 2021
University of Notre Dame Ph.D. student in Philosophy (transferred)	Aug 2020–Jul 2021
University of Crete, Rethymnon (Greece) 3rd Creteling Summer School in Linguistics	Jul 2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

PRIMARY INSTRUCTOR:

Introduction to Philosophy (Rutgers)	Summer 2025
Introduction to Formal Reasoning and Decision Making (Rutgers)	Spring 2025
Introduction to Logic (Rutgers)	Fall 2024
Introduction to Ethics (Rutgers)	Summer 2024
Philosophy of Language (Rutgers)	Spring 2024
Introduction to Logic (Rutgers)	Winter 2024
Introduction to Logic (Rutgers)	Winter 2023

TEACHING ASSISTANT:

Current Moral and Social Issues (Frances Kamm, Rutgers)	Spring 2023
Critical Reasoning and Informal Logic (Ken Ito, UConn)	Summer 2020
Philosophy and Social Ethics (Thomas Bontly, UConn)	Fall 2020
Philosophy and Logic (Marcus Rossberg, UConn)	Spring 2019
Philosophy and Social Ethics (Paul Bloomfield, UConn)	Fall 2019

GRADING ASSISTANT:

Introduction to Philosophy of Language (Jeffrey King, Rutgers)	Fall 2022
Introduction to Philosophy (Virginia Sharpe, Rutgers)	Fall 2022
Introduction to Ethics (Justin Kalef, Rutgers)	Fall 2021

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Coördinator of Logic & Metaphysics Workshop (CUNY)	Sep 2025–present
Reviewer for: <i>Mind, Ling. & Phil., Phil. Stud., Synthese, Phil. Quart., J of Semantics, S & P</i>	May 2023–Present
Coördinator of Rutgers Philosophy Colloquium Committee (Rutgers)	May 2023–Dec 2024
Coördinator of Philosophy of Language Reading Group (Rutgers)	Jan 2022–Feb 2024
Coördinator of Modality Reading Group (Notre Dame)	Aug 2020–May 2021
President of Philosophy Graduate Student Association (UConn)	Aug 2019–Aug 2020

GRADUATE COURSEWORK

Rutgers University, New Brunswick

Aug 2021–Present

Early Modern Philosophy (18th Century); Seminar in Philosophy of Language: Reference; Seminar in Cognitive Science: Pejorative Language; Advanced Topics in Philosophy of Language: Logic and Natural Language; Social and Political Philosophy: Identity Politics

University of Notre Dame

Aug 2020–Jul 2021

Advanced Topics in Metaphysics: Universals; Advanced Topics in Logic: Non-Classical Logic; Advanced Topics in Ethics: Metaethics; History of Analytic Philosophy: Frege, Carnap, Quine

University of Connecticut, Storrs

Aug 2018–Aug 2020

Semantics I; Semantics II; Topics in Math. Logic: Computability Theory; Seminar in Contemporary Philosophy; Seminar in Modal Logic; Non-Classical Logic; Computational Linguistics; Seminar in Philosophy of Language: Plurals; Philosophy of Religion; Topics in Semantics: Inquisitive Semantics; Seminar in Philosophy of Language; Seminar in Philosophical Logic

DISSERTATION SUMMARY

My dissertation studies puzzles about modality. It develops a “schmentencist” approach: instead of treating modal vocabulary as primitive logical operators that apply to full sentences, I argue that natural language grammar encodes modality via variables and object-language quantifiers over worlds. Modals are thus quantifiers that combine not with full sentences but with something like the first-order analogue of open formulae, which I call *schmentences*, following David Lewis.

I motivate this conclusion with (often cross-linguistic) evidence from mood morphology, showing that many patterns in how mood appears in natural language favor the schmentencist treatment. I pay special attention to vacuous interpretations of the subjunctive mood and *de re* interpretations of the indicative mood.

The dissertation then articulates a broader vision about content and communication. Schmentencism seems to preclude treating the denotation of a sentence as a set of possible worlds. But this possible-worlds account of propositions is needed for familiar purposes, such as modeling an information state, comparing alternatives, or giving a standard account of what a speaker asserts. A central contribution I make is to show that we can indeed maintain this conception of proposition within a schmentencist grammar if we liberalize how we conceive of compositional semantics, and in particular if we allow a bit of Fregeanism into it according to which sentence contribute, at once, both an extension and an intension when they embed under modals.

As part of the dissertation, I look at non-specific *de re* readings of indefinite descriptions, since the main way to account for them involves a schmentencist approach (explicit world variables). However, I argue that this approach fails for this phenomenon and then proceed to offer a higher-order, counterpart theory that captures it more adequately.

LANGUAGES

Albanian: Native

Modern Greek: Native

English: Full Proficiency, C2

Portuguese: Advanced High, C1

French: Advanced Mid, B2

Spanish: Advanced Mid, B2

Ancient Greek: Reading Proficiency, A2

REFERENCES (CONTACT DETAILS)

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2. **Zoltán Gendler Szabó**
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